SESSION PLAN

Unit Code and Title:	**Unit 513: Design and Develop E-Learning Resources**
Session number:	**3** ***From Design to Digital: Developing High-Impact E-Learning Materials***
Trainer's name:	**Marie G.**
Date:	**14/03/2026**
Duration:	**6 hours**
Location:	**The Training Academy of Excellence**

Learning Objective/s:

By the end of this session, learners will be able to:

- *Develop structured e-learning course shells and content templates using classification techniques.*
- *Create interactive media components and activities that progress and engage learners.*
- *Apply Mayer's Multimedia Principles and Cognitive Load Theory to digital content development.*
- *Produce guidance materials for trainers and maintain required administrative registers.*

Facilitation Method:

The session will employ a blended, hands-on workshop approach. Given the learner profiles—which highlight a strong preference for "Thinking" (analysing theory) and "Applying" (practical experimentation) —the facilitation will follow a Theory-to-Practice model:

- Direct Instruction: Brief theory presentations on Mayer's Principles and Cognitive Load Theory.
- Collaborative Learning: Group work to develop course shells, catering to learners like Abbey who value teamwork and communication.
- Kinaesthetic/Active Learning: Hands-on digital creation of interactive components to meet the needs of multimodal and practical learners.
- Individual Coaching: Providing constructive feedback during practical tasks, as requested by Sian to maintain motivation.

Resources needed:

- Presentation: Digital slides covering Mayer's Principles and Cognitive Load Theory.
- Examples: Samples of "bad" vs. "good" e-learning slides for the audit activity.
- Hardware: Digital devices (laptops/tablets) with internet access for each learner.
- Software: Access to an E-learning Authoring Tool (e.g., H5P, Canva) and a Learning Management System (LMS) shell. Miro board or Padlet board
- Templates: Digital content templates and classification checklists.

- Materials: Digital guides for creating asynchronous tools and trainer guidance snippets. Audit Checklist: A simple 1-page digital rubric based on Mayer's Principles.
- PPT presentation
- Whiteboard, projector and internet access.

Learning Support

- Technical Support: Specific guidance on using digital e-learning tools, as some learners have identified "Using Computers" as an area they may sometimes need help with.
- Step-by-Step Instructions: Provision of clear, written instructional scaffolds for the "hands-on" digital tasks to support self-directed learners like Shammim.
- Visual Aids: High-impact visual examples to illustrate abstract design theories.
- Time Management: Structured "check-ins" to help learners manage the intensive 6-hour duration, especially those with external work/family commitments.

Learning Environment

- Physical Space: A flexible classroom equipped with stable Wi-Fi and power outlets for devices.
- Layout: Group clusters of tables to facilitate the "Blueprint" group activity and "Discussion" segments.
- Atmosphere: A collaborative, professional studio-like environment

where learners can share screens and peer-review each other's interactive components.

Session Structure and Timings

Provide a breakdown of each topic you will cover in the session. Please add or delete rows as necessary

Time	Topic / Activity	Content / trainer instructions	Learning Activities / Formative Assessments	Resources
1h 30mins	The Science of Seeing: Mayer's Principles	**Trainer** **Presentation** Applying Mayer's Principles (Coherence, Signaling, Redundancy) to e-learning templates.	**Learners** **Activity:** Audit a "bad" slide/page and redesign it using a content template. Triner presents learners with a "bad" e-learning slide or digital page. This example is intentionally designed to violate several of Mayer's Multimedia Principles and Cognitive Load Theory.	PPT presentation Bad Slide" Samples: Digital files (PPT or PDF) showing poorly designed e-learning pages. Audit Checklist: A simple 1-page digital rubric based on Mayer's Principles.

			Learners must use a checklist to identify why the slide is ineffective. Finally, learners use a Standardized Content Template to rebuild the information, applying Mayer's principals.	
2h	The Blueprint: Course Shells & Hierarchy	**Trainer** **Presentation:** To design an effective e-learning environment, you must move from a broad idea to a structured digital map. This involves building the "shell" (the outer framework) and organizing the "inventory" (the internal content) so learners don't get lost.	**Learners** **Activity:** Group work developing a course content shell for a unit using classification techniques. First, learners work in small groups to list every piece of information or task a student needs for a specific unit. • *Example:* Videos, PDF	PPT presentation Sticky Notes or Digital Collaboration Tool (e.g., Miro/Padlet): To move "topics" around until the order makes sense. Classification Checklist: A simple guide that asks: *"Is this a Module, a Topic, or an Activity?"*

		Discussion: Intuitive vs. Frustrating apps Think of a website or app you hate using. Is the menu hidden? Is the "next" button hard to find?	readings, a quiz, a discussion forum, and an assignment link. Now, learners use classification techniques to group these items: • The Modules • The Topics within the module • The actual activities Learners create the map	
2h	Interactivity & Asynchronous Tools	**Trainer** Demonstrates embedding self-marking quizzes and interactive media.	**Learners** Hands-on: Develop one interactive component (e.g., drag-and-drop) and embed a digital tool (e.g., self-marking	Active demonstration Practice e-learning authoring tool e.g. H5P with quiz builders

			quiz) **AT1** Portfolio 3: The Resource: Develop a content learning object using a content creation tool	
1h	The Guide: Supporting the Trainer	**Trainer** **Discussion** The importance of guidance for VET teachers/assessors.	**Learners** **Activity:** Draft a "Trainer Guide" snippet detailing learner support and technical troubleshooting. Trainer provides learners with Scenario Cards: Small cards with "gripe" examples (e.g., *"I can't see the text because it's too small" or "I don't know how to use the new tool" etc*) to give learners a starting point for their troubleshooting.	Scenario cards